

gemstone-py Cookbook

Task-focused recipes for daily use

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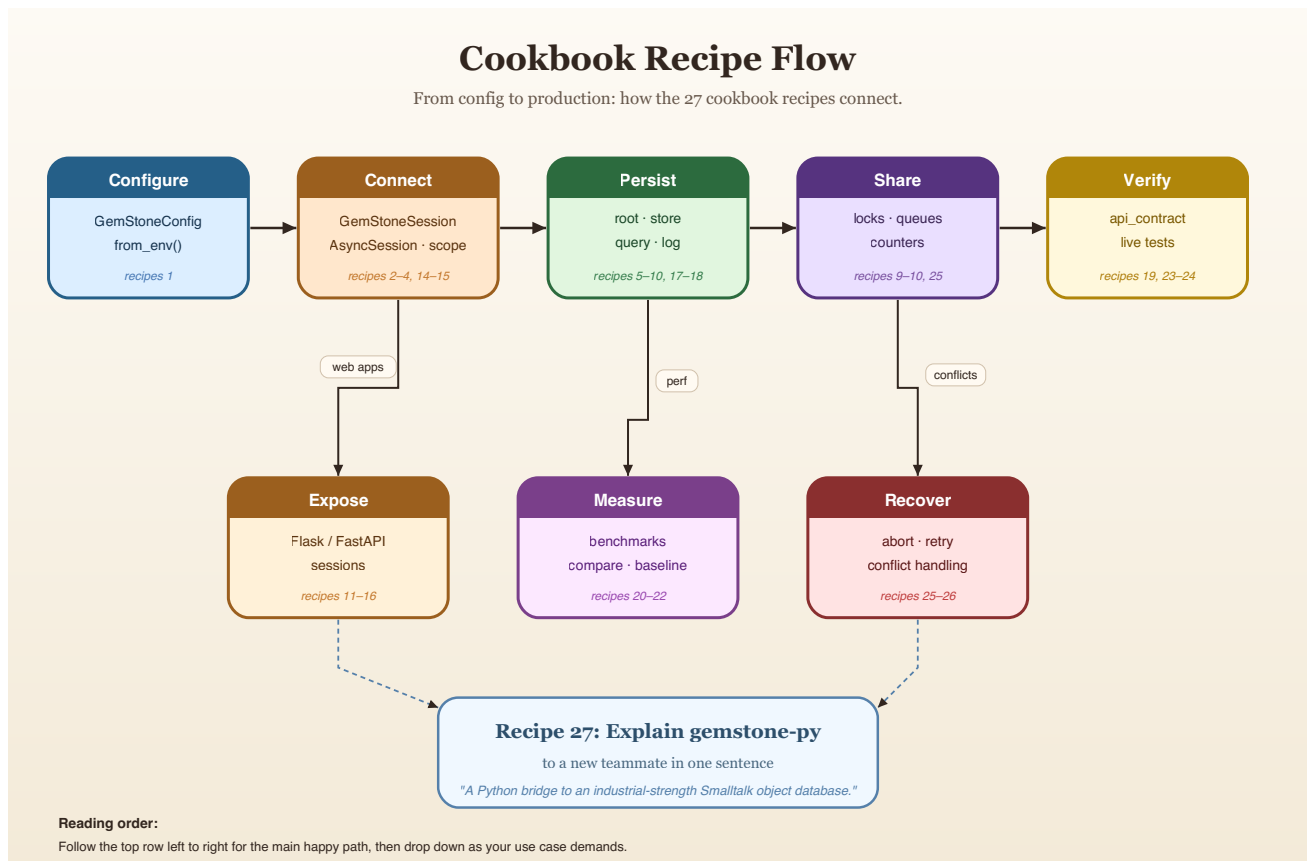
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Cookbook

This cookbook is a collection of direct recipes. Each one is deliberately short enough to copy, adapt, and keep moving.



Recipe 1: Open a Session and Evaluate Smalltalk

```
from gemstone_py import GemStoneConfig, GemStoneSession

config = GemStoneConfig.from_env()

with GemStoneSession(config=config) as session:
    print(session.eval("3 factorial"))
```

Use this when:

- you want the smallest live sanity check
- you need to inspect a repository value quickly

Recipe 2: Commit a Write Safely

```
from gemstone_py import GemStoneConfig, TransactionPolicy, GemStoneSession
from gemstone_py.persistent_root import PersistentRoot

config = GemStoneConfig.from_env()

with GemStoneSession(
    config=config,
    transaction_policy=TransactionPolicy.COMMIT_ON_SUCCESS,
) as session:
    root = PersistentRoot(session)
    root["CookbookExample"] = {"answer": 42}
```

Why this recipe exists:

- it avoids the classic "the write seemed to work but vanished" mistake

Recipe 3: Read From PersistentRoot

```
from gemstone_py import GemStoneSession
from gemstone_py.persistent_root import PersistentRoot

with GemStoneSession(config=config) as session:
    root = PersistentRoot(session)
    print(root["CookbookExample"])
```

Recipe 4: Use session_scope(...)

```
from gemstone_py import GemStoneConfig, session_scope
from gemstone_py.persistent_root import PersistentRoot

config = GemStoneConfig.from_env()

with session_scope(config=config) as session:
    root = PersistentRoot(session)
    root["ScopedWork"] = {"kind": "unit-of-work"}
```

This is the recipe to prefer in application code.

Recipe 5: Create a Named GSCollection

```
from gemstone_py.gsquery import GSCollection

people = GSCollection("CookbookPeople", config=config)
people.insert({"@name": "Ada", "@city": "London"})
people.insert({"@name": "Grace", "@city": "New York"})
people.add_index("@city")
```

Recipe 6: Search an Indexed Collection

```
matches = people.search("@city", "eq1", "London")
for row in matches:
    print(row)
```

Use `GSCollection` when you need repeated search, not when you merely enjoy the idea of repeated search.

Recipe 7: Keep a Store-Like Dataset in GStore

```
from gemstone_py.gstore import GStore

store = GStore("cookbook.db", config=config)
store["sku:hat"] = {"name": "Hat", "stock": 8}
store["sku:cape"] = {"name": "Cape", "stock": 3}
print(store["sku:hat"])
```

Recipe 8: Append a Persistent Event Log Entry

```
from gemstone_py.objectlog import ObjectLog

log = ObjectLog(config=config)
log.info("inventory_adjusted", {"sku": "hat", "delta": -1})
```

Later:

```
for entry in log.entries():
    print(entry)
```

Recipe 9: Share a Counter Between Sessions

```
from gemstone_py.concurrency import RCCounter

with session_scope(config=config) as session:
    counter = RCCounter(session)
    counter += 1
```

Use shared counters when the number truly lives in GemStone, not when a local integer would do and you are simply feeling theatrical.

Recipe 10: Share a Queue

```
from gemstone_py.concurrency import RCQueue
from gemstone_py.persistent_root import PersistentRoot

with session_scope(config=config) as session:
    root = PersistentRoot(session)
    root["WorkQueue"] = RCQueue(session)
```

Recipe 11: Install Flask Request Sessions

```
from flask import Flask
from gemstone_py import GemStoneConfig, install_flask_request_session

app = Flask(__name__)

install_flask_request_session(
    app,
    config=GemStoneConfig.from_env(),
    pool_size=4,
)
```

This is the default production-friendly shape.

Recipe 12: Use a Thread-Local Provider for Simpler Hosting

```
install_flask_request_session(
    app,
    config=GemStoneConfig.from_env(),
```

```
        thread_local=True,  
    )
```

Good when the server model is simple and you want one session per thread.

Recipe 13: Inspect Provider Health

```
from gemstone_py import flask_request_session_provider_snapshot  
  
@app.get("/health/gemstone")  
def gemstone_health():  
    return flask_request_session_provider_snapshot()
```

Operational visibility is better than optimism.

Recipe 14: Open an Async Session

```
from gemstone_py import GemStoneConfig  
from gemstone_py.aio import AsyncSession  
  
config = GemStoneConfig.from_env()  
  
async with AsyncSession.connect(config=config) as session:  
    print(await session.eval("3 + 4"))
```

Use this when the surrounding application is already async.

Recipe 15: Use an Async Transaction

```
async with AsyncSession.connect(config=config) as session:  
    async with session.transaction():  
        root = session.root()  
        await root.set("AsyncCookbook", {"status": "ok"})
```

The transaction context commits on success and aborts on exception.

Recipe 16: Add FastAPI Dependency Injection

```
from fastapi import Depends, FastAPI  
from gemstone_py import GemStoneConfig  
from gemstone_py.aio import AsyncSession
```

```

from gemstone_py.aio.fastapi import session_dependency

app = FastAPI()
get_gemstone = session_dependency(config=GemStoneConfig.from_env())

@app.get("/health/gemstone")
async def gemstone_health(session: AsyncSession = Depends(get_gemstone)):
    return {"result": await session.eval("3 + 4")}

```

Recipe 17: Query With a Typed Protocol

```

from typing import Protocol
from gemstone_py.gsquery import GSCollection

class PostRecord(Protocol):
    title: str
    status: str

posts = GSCollection("SimplePosts", config=config).query(PostRecord)
for post in posts.where(lambda row: row.status == "published").all():
    print(post.title)

```

The lambda records an indexed GemStone path. It is not called for every row in Python.

Recipe 18: Generate a Typed Smalltalk Wrapper

```

from typing import Protocol
from gemstone_py import gemstone_class, gemstone_selector

@gemstone_class("OkzBooking", async_=True)
class OkzBookingProto(Protocol):
    status: str

    @classmethod
    @gemstone_selector("findById:")
    def find_by_id(cls, booking_id: str) -> "OkzBookingProto":
        ...

    def mark_paid(self, at_posix_seconds: int) -> None:
        ...

```

Generate and check in the wrapper:

```

gemstone-codegen \
  --module examples.typed_access.codegen_demo.models \

```



```
--output examples/typed_access/codegen_demo/generated \  
--clean
```

Use it without hand-writing the class-side Smalltalk string:

```
from examples.typed_access.codegen_demo.generated import OkzBooking  
  
booking = OkzBooking.find_by_id(session, "B-1001")  
print(booking.status)  
booking.mark_paid(1_779_912_000)
```

Recipe 19: Keep an OOP Alive Explicitly

```
with GemStoneSession(config=config) as session:  
    ref = session.execute_managed("OrderedCollection new")  
    ref.send("add:", session.new_string("kept"))  
    print(ref.print_string())  
    ref.close()
```

For a raw OOP:

```
with session.handle(raw_oop) as handle:  
    print(handle.send("printString"))
```

Recipe 20: Check the Native Backend

```
python -m pip install "gemstone-py[fast]"  
python -m examples.native_backend.check_backend
```

Force a backend before Python starts:

```
GEMSTONE_PY_GCI_BACKEND=ctypes python -m examples.native_backend.check_backend  
GEMSTONE_PY_GCI_BACKEND=native python -m examples.native_backend.check_backend
```

Recipe 21: Run the Maintained Benchmarks

```
gemstone-benchmarks --entries 500 --search-runs 20
```

Or emit JSON:

```
gemstone-benchmarks --json --output benchmark-report.json
```

Recipe 22: Compare Benchmark Reports

```
gemstone-benchmark-compare old.json new.json --json --output compare.json
```

That turns performance arguments into evidence, which is disappointingly healthy.

Recipe 23: Register a New Accepted Benchmark Baseline

```
gemstone-benchmark-baseline-register \  
benchmark-report.json \  
--manifest .github/benchmarks/index.json
```

Recipe 24: Verify the Installed Artifact

```
python -m gemstone_py.api_contract --json
```

This is useful after installation, after release, and after any moment when you feel your package metadata may have become sentient.

For a full PyPI/TestPyPI release check:

```
gemstone-publish-verify --gemstone-version 0.2.10 --native-version 0.1.2
```

That command checks project JSON, version-specific JSON, the simple index, and temporary-virtualenv installs for both the pure package and native package.

Recipe 25: Scaffold and Run Module-Style Migrations

Create a numbered migration file:

```
gemstone-migrations scaffold add_amount_to_booking --directory migrations
```

A migration module exposes `upgrade(session)`, optional `downgrade(session)`, and optional `dependencies`:

```
id = "002_add_amount_to_booking"
dependencies = ("001_initial",)

def upgrade(session):
    session.eval(
        "OkzBooking addInstVarName: 'amount' ifAbsent: [ nil ]"
    )
    session.commit()

def downgrade(session):
    session.eval(
        "OkzBooking removeInstVarName: 'amount' ifAbsent: [ nil ]"
    )
    session.commit()
```

Register modules in a manifest and apply them:

```
from gemstone_py import GemStoneConfig, GemStoneSession
from gemstone_py.migrations import current_version, load_manifest, upgrade

steps = load_manifest("my_app.migrations.manifest")

with GemStoneSession(config=GemStoneConfig.from_env()) as session:
    print(current_version(session))
    print(upgrade(session, steps, dry_run=True))
    upgrade(session, steps)
```

Applied versions are recorded under `GemstonePyMigrations` in `UserGlobals`. The runner refuses to continue when the stone has applied migrations that are missing from the local manifest, or when a stored migration checksum differs from the local file. Real `upgrade` and `downgrade` runs acquire an advisory lock in `UserGlobals` before applying steps; dry-runs do not.

The same operations are available from the command line:

```
gemstone-migrations current
gemstone-migrations status --manifest my_app.migrations.manifest
gemstone-migrations plan --manifest my_app.migrations.manifest
gemstone-migrations upgrade --manifest my_app.migrations.manifest --dry-run
gemstone-migrations upgrade --manifest my_app.migrations.manifest --dry-run --record
gemstone-migrations upgrade --manifest my_app.migrations.manifest
gemstone-migrations downgrade --manifest my_app.migrations.manifest --target
001_initial
```

For a stale lock left by a crashed process, use a deliberate override:

```
gemstone-migrations upgrade --manifest my_app.migrations.manifest \  
  --force-lock --lock-owner release-2026-05-11
```

`--dry-run --record` uses a recording session for callbacks and prints common session calls such as `session.eval(...)`, `execute(...)`, `perform_value(...)`, `commit()`, and `abort()` without sending them to GemStone.

Example recorded output:

```
dry-run upgrade: 1 step(s)  
  002_add_amount_to_booking  
recorded operations:  
  # upgrade 002_add_amount_to_booking  
  session.eval("OkzBooking addInstVarName: 'amount' ifAbsent: [ nil ]")  
  session.commit()
```

Treat recorded dry-runs as a release review aid. Migrations that depend on live query results still need a real staging run because the recorder returns placeholder OOPs and never reads from GemStone.

To compare a local Protocol or type witness with the live GemStone class before writing the next migration:

```
gemstone-migrations diff-class OkzBooking \  
  --local-class my_app.models:OkzBookingProto
```

The output lists missing and extra instance variables and prints advisory `session.eval(...)` lines for a reviewed migration.

Recipe 26: Run the Live Test Lane

```
GS_RUN_LIVE=1 ./scripts/run_live_checks.sh
```

Longer soak run:

```
GS_RUN_LIVE=1 GS_RUN_LIVE_SOAK=1 ./scripts/run_live_checks.sh
```

Recipe 27: Handle Commit Conflicts Without Pretending They Are Rare

When multiple sessions modify overlapping state, conflicts are normal. The right pattern:

```
from gemstone_py import GemStoneConfig, GemStoneSession, TransactionPolicy
from gemstone_py.concurrency import CommitConflictError

config = GemStoneConfig.from_env()

for attempt in range(3):
    with GemStoneSession(config=config,
                        transaction_policy=TransactionPolicy.MANUAL) as session:
        try:
            # reload data each attempt — previous read is stale after abort
            root = PersistentRoot(session)
            root["counter"] = (root.get("counter") or 0) + 1
            session.commit()
            break
        except CommitConflictError:
            session.abort()
            if attempt == 2:
                raise
```

Rules:

- keep the write unit small
- reload data after every abort — the previous read is stale
- bound the retry count — do not loop forever
- log conflicts — frequent conflicts signal a design smell, not bad luck

Recipe 28: Learn a Queue With a Hat

The hat trick example is memorable because it teaches a real primitive through a slightly ridiculous scenario. You should keep more examples like that in your own codebase than you probably do.

Recipe 29: Explain gemstone-py to a New Teammate

Use this sentence:

"It is a Python package that talks directly to GemStone Smalltalk, keeps transactions explicit, gives us persistence helpers instead of a fake ORM, supports async, typed access, managed OOP lifetimes, and optional native wheels, and already has real CI, release, benchmark, and live verification lanes."

That sentence has rescued several meetings already. At minimum, it should rescue yours.

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